

Motorola Edge 40

An impressive mid-range phone with undeniable panache

Motorola phones have garnered quite a bit of acclaim in the past few years for two primary reasons – their bloatware-free MyUX skin and the slim and lightweight form factor of most of its phones. In fact, the Motorola Edge 30 which launched last year was THE thinnest 5G smartphone in the world! Cut to 2023, and we've got the successor of the Edge 30, the Motorola Edge 40, which comes with a flurry of improvements over its predecessor. However, this comes at the cost of a more bulky form factor than the Edge 30. Regardless, it continues to be one of the lightest 5G smartphones on the market. So, at ₹29,999, is the new Motorola Edge 40 worth your money and how does it perform? Let's delve right into it.

BUILD AND DESIGN

Let's get the bad out of the way first. As I mentioned before, the Motorola Edge 40 is no longer as slim and lightweight as its predecessor. The Edge 40 is available in three colourways – Nebula Green, Lunar Blue, and Eclipse Black – out of which the Green and Black variant sport premium-looking vegan leather backs while the Blue variant sports a matte PMMA (plastic) back. The Nebula Green leather variant I got for review weighs 171 g, which is 16 grams more than the good ol' Edge 30. It is also thicker – 7.6 mm compared to 6.8 mm.

If you keep the Motorola Edge 30 out of the equation, this is still an extremely sleek 5G phone. In fact, Motorola claims that the Edge 40 is the "slimmest and lightest 5G phone with IP68 water protection". And that's the key factor here. The Edge 40 now comes with IP68 dust and water resistance, which was missing on the Edge 30 (the phone was simply dubbed water-repellent). For us, this tradeoff for a better design and IP rating doesn't seem too bad, but you be the judge for yourself.



aluminium frame, and the classy-looking camera module that blends into the rest of the rear panel. The inconspicuous Motorola logo looks great as well and the rounded edges of the front display and the back panel add to the premium factor. Also, due to the rounded edges and weight, this is one of the most comfortable phones.

DISPLAY

Motorola has jammed pack its display with impressive specifications. For example, it comes with a 144 Hz refresh rate pOLED display that rivals most of the competitors in this price range. Motorola has added a curved display to the Edge 40 which makes it look very sleek and stylish, but it could provoke a lot of accidental touches. The 6.55-inch pOLED display sports an FHD+ resolution and HDR10+ support. There's support for Edge ambient lighting as well, to notify users about calls and messages. I recall this feature being quite popular on older Samsung flagships and

it's nice to see this make a comeback. The display is bright, vibrant and crisp. I also found the viewing angles to be excellent. Sunlight visibility is no problem since the display can get sufficiently bright – even for outdoors usage. I tested the phone's display with a LUX meter and got a reading of 801 nits under direct sunlight, using Auto Brightness, which is not a bad number at all. Motorola claims 1200 nits of peak brightness though, and I didn't get a result anywhere close to that number.

The Motorola Edge 40 sports an impressive display, but there's one hiccup. The 144 Hz refresh rate support can be used but at the cost of severe battery drain. This is because Moto's Adaptive Refresh rate mode on this phone doesn't go all the way up to 144 Hz and remains capped at 120 Hz. So, if you want to experience 144 Hz – a feature you've paid money for – you will have to keep it toggled on at all times, which can severely deplete the phone's battery life. We hope Motorola can fix this with a software update in the near future.

PERFORMANCE

The Motorola Edge 40 is the world's first phone to feature the spanning-new MediaTek Dimensity 8020 SoC. It essentially sports the same core configuration as the older Dimensity 1100 but in my testing, I found that it scored higher in benchmarks, so there could be some extra tuning done. The Edge 40 comes packing 8 GB LPDDR4X RAM and 256 GB UFS 3.1 storage. There's no expandable storage though, which is disappointing.

Let's start with synthetic benchmarks. I decided to pit the Motorola Edge 40 against similarly-priced competitors including the POCO F5, iQOO Neo 7, Samsung Galaxy A34, and OPPO Reno 8T. In AnTuTu, the phone sits somewhere right in the middle of the pack. It scored an impressive 6,47,389 which is not as blazing fast as the gaming mid-range champs – Poco F5 and iQOO Neo 7 – but its considerably better than the Samsung Galaxy A34 and OPPO Reno 8T.

I also ran GeekBench, and in the Single Core test, the Motorola Edge 40 squeaked out 1,112 points while in the Multi-Core test, it got a score of 3,557. Here, it still lags behind the POCO F5 considerably but it